

SURYANSH UPMANYU

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EDUCATION

The University Of Texas At Austin

Ph.D. in Economics

August 2021 - June 2027 (Anticipated)

Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi Center

M.S. in Quantitative Economics

July 2017 - June 2019

St. Stephen's College, University of Delhi

B.A. in Economics (Honours)

July 2014 - June 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Labor Economics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Which Skills Matter? Why New College Graduates Are Falling Behind

With Aniket Baksy and Anushka Mitra

The unemployment rate for young college graduates has worsened in recent years. This has happened along with a rise in demand for noncognitive skills by employers. We argue that noncognitive skills can only be accumulated on the job, implying that the increase in demand for such skills harms young workers disproportionately since they enter the labor market without any work experience. We use a general equilibrium search-and-matching model with heterogeneous firms and workers, calibrated to the US labor market during the early 2010s to study this mechanism. Our model shows that skill-biased technical change shifts employer demand towards high-skilled workers, and this explains 36% of the worsening of the unemployment rate for young college graduates.

WORKING PAPERS

Effects of Pay Transparency on the U.S. Labor Market *(Submitted)*

With Raymond He

Many major US jurisdictions have implemented pay transparency laws that require firms to advertise wage offers in vacancy postings. Using data on the near universe of job postings and representative survey data in a difference-in-differences framework, we find that these laws increased the fraction of postings with wage information by 24.7 percentage points. This translated to average real wage increases of 3.2% - 4.4% in Colorado and 0.6% - 1.3% in California and Washington. We further consistently find significant positive effects on real wages for workers who are male, have a college degree, or are over forty years old.

Can A More Generous Unemployment Insurance System Improve Job Outcomes?

I study the effects of unemployment insurance (UI) on an unemployed individual's job outcomes upon re-employment using data from the National Longitudinal Survey of Youth. I find that a 10% increase in UI benefits leads to a 2.6% longer unemployment duration and 1.9-3.3% higher wages upon re-employment. This increase in wages is not driven by an improvement in match quality, since UI does not affect the match quality between an individual's skills and the skill requirements of their occupation. Instead, a higher UI amount increases the value of remaining unemployed, allowing unemployed individuals to bargain for higher wages.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Sanger Learning Center Supplemental Instruction Supervisor for Economics	<i>Fall 2025 -</i>
Macroeconomic Theory Teaching Assistant For Prof. Trenton Herriford	<i>Spring 2025</i>
International Economics Teaching Assistant For Prof. Trenton Herriford	<i>Fall 2024</i>
Introduction To Microeconomics Teaching Assistant For Prof. Dirk Mateer	<i>Summer 2024</i>
Time Series Econometrics Grader For Prof. Sahil Ravgotra	<i>Spring 2024</i>
Law And Economics Teaching Assistant For Prof. Allan King	<i>Spring 2024</i>
Wealth And Well-Being Teaching Assistant For Prof. Dirk Mateer	<i>Fall 2023</i>
Industrial Organization Grader For Prof. Shalah Mostashari	<i>Summer 2023</i>
Introduction To Microeconomics Teaching Assistant For Prof. Dirk Mateer	<i>Summer 2023</i>
Introduction To Econometrics Teaching Assistant For Prof. Helen Schneider	<i>Fall 2021 - Spring 2023</i>

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Summer Research Fellowship, The University Of Texas At Austin	<i>2025, 2026</i>
Professional Development Award, The University Of Texas At Austin	<i>2024, 2025, 2026</i>
Data Purchase Grant, The University Of Texas At Austin	<i>2023</i>
Departmental Fellowship, The University Of Texas At Austin	<i>2021 - 2026</i>
Honorary Book Grant, Indian Statistical Institute	<i>2017, 2018</i>
Goutham Krishna Research Fellowship, St. Stephen's College	<i>2016 - 2017</i>
National Talent Search Examination Scholarship, NCERT	<i>2010 - 2017</i>

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES

2026: Society of Labor Economists' Annual Meeting (USA)
2025: Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference (USA), Royal Economic Society Annual Conference (UK), STATA TX Empirical Microeconomics Conference (USA), European Winter Meeting Of The Econometric Society (Cyprus), Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (India)
2024: Delhi School of Economics Winter School (India)

PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

Home Credit India

June 2019 - May 2021

- Developed refinancing strategies during the COVID-19 pandemic moratorium to maximize the repayment capability of borrowers while maintaining the solvency of Home Credit India.
- Validated and monitored credit-scoring models using econometrics and statistical learning tools for the underwriting of consumer loans.

REFERENCES

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OTHER

Programming

R, Python, STATA, Julia, L^AT_EX, Matlab, SQL

Citizenship

Indian, F1 Visa

Languages

English (Fluent), Hindi (Native), German (B1 level)

Last Updated: August 25, 2026